The Phone Book at the Pond

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 4, Episode 19

The last tray held several books with circles and bright lines on their covers. Lark kept the confirmed request beside them. Nib looked at each title before admiring the pictures. The waiting reader had asked for the history of messages called Phone.

“A phone with paper pages,” Nib murmured, delighted. “A story about messages,” Lark explained warmly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **when**

“Ph can write /f/ in phone and graph,” Lark modeled clearly. “The sound is familiar from fan, but this spelling needs its own model. Join ph with the long o pattern in phone. Keep the letter team together rather than sounding p and h separately.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try phone, graph. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read Phone on the closed covers,” Lark invited warmly. “Which title matches the confirmed request?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The phone is by the book. I can make a graph.**

“What can the speaker make?” Lark asked gently. “Which sentence is about the phone instead?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib carried the selected book to the stable rest. Lark placed its current slip with the prepared receipt and entered the fourth loan once. All four requested books now had borrowers, destinations, and records. The Storyboat turned toward home with its lending job complete.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write phone beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal showed Phone on its borrowed reading rest. The four loans stayed with their readers for their agreed times. The boat could return to its berth for a celebration that matched the real lending record.